

Kurukshetra University -- have been declared autonomous.

The government has approved the upgradation of the YMCA Institute of Engineering, Faridabad, to a university and to make DBCR University of Science and Technology, Murthal, and Guru Jambheshwar University of Science and Technology, Hisar, as affiliating universities, says Technical Education Secretary P K Gupta.

Four state-of-the-art institutes

State Institute of Fashion and Design, State Institute of Film and Television, State Institute of Fine Arts and State Institute of Professional Studies - are being established at Rohtak. Could it be imagined five years back?

Focus on quality

Modern world industrial culture wants high quality products. This is possible if we have quality education. The government is not compromising as far as providing quality in these institutes is concerned, says Technical Education Director M P Gupta, adding that it has introduced credit-based system in government engineering colleges, has notified a student's charter and effected inter-se grading of all institutes. Besides, it has made quality certification mandatory in addition to making the curriculum and academic calendar of all state universities uniform.

Polytechnics

Between 2000 and 2005, only two government polytechnics were set up. Up to 2005, there were only 15 government polytechnics. From 2006 onwards, 10 new government polytechnics were made functional.

Enhanced budget allocation

Chief Secretary Dharamvir says the plan budget of the department which was a meagre Rs 29 crore in 2004-05 has increased to Rs 315 crore for the current year. Largescale construction work, including the new teaching blocks, hostels and laboratories worth Rs 250 crore have been sanctioned and the sanction for works worth Rs 150 crore is in the pipeline. The Chief Minister has agreed to provide additional funds of Rs 50 crore to the department. Also, a loan of Rs 1,321.8 lakh has been sanctioned by the National Capital Regional Planning Board for the establishment of the Deenbandhu Chhotu Ram Government Polytechnic at Sampla.

Social Welfare Schemes

The government has taken some solid affirmative action to see that the underprivileged do not miss the party, says Technical Education Minister A C Chaudhary. Among the classes benefiting from reservation and scholarships are girls, minority, scheduled caste, physically handicapped, Kashmiri migrants, rural youths and economically weaker sections. The icing on the cake, however, is the government's admiration for its achievers. In a first-of-its-kind gesture, the Chief Minister, Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda, feted talented students of the state at his official



residence, sending across a powerful message that the government's inclusive concerns notwithstanding, those breaking the glass ceiling on their own shall continue to occupy a pride of place.

The juggernaut rolls on with a government determined to take things to the next level. The young MP from Rohtak, Mr Deepinder Hooda's persistence has brought the IIM to Rohtak. The Rajiv Gandhi Education City at Sonapat is attracting the attention of global players in the field of technical education. The diverse industrial base of the state is finding reflection in a number of areas in which top-class institutions are coming up - plastic engineering, information technology, fashion and design, film and television, fine arts, to name a few. ■



5,000-crore private sector investment in technical education has been crystallised during the term of the government. National-level institutes such as IIM, IFT and CIPET are being set up

